

Student Intake Snapshot

Teacher Copy · Oral · ~5 min · New Student Triage

INTAKE AS
ASSESSMENT

Student: _____

Grade: _____

Date: _____

Triage assessment — not a deep dive. Goal: find which 2-3 skill areas to go deeper on next session.

1 Rhyming

Say: "Do cat and hat rhyme? ... Now tell me a word that rhymes with sun."

Word / Prompt	Expected	✓ / ✗
cat / hat — rhyme?	-> YES	✓ ✗
sun — rhymes with?	-> any -un word	✓ ✗

Misses either -> Phonological Awareness is the starting point. Do not move to phonics yet.

2 Letter Sounds

Say: "What sound does this letter make? — the sound, not the name."

s	m	b	f	sh	ch	th
/s/	/m/	/b/	/f/	/sh/	/ch/	/th/
✓ ✗	✓ ✗	✓ ✗	✓ ✗	✓ ✗	✓ ✗	✓ ✗

Misses 3+ letters -> start with Alphabet Knowledge. Misses only sh/ch/th -> UFLI Units 5-7 is the target.

3 Decode & Spell

Say: "I'm going to say a word — write it out or say each sound you hear."

Word / Prompt	Expected	✓ / ✗
sat	-> CVC — K level	✓ ✗
ship	-> digraph — 1st grade level	✓ ✗
cake	-> magic-e — 2nd grade level	✓ ✗

Misses 'sat' -> UFLI Units 1-4. Misses 'ship' -> Units 5-7. Misses 'cake' -> Unit 14 is the target.

4 Nonsense Word Check

Say: "Read this real word... now read this silly made-up word with the same sounds."

Real Word	Student Read	Nonsense Word	Student Read	Match?
hop	_____	fop	_____	✓ X
cake	_____	vake	_____	✓ X

Reads real word but fails nonsense -> memorizing without decoding. Flag Phonics Automaticity — critical to address.

5 Oral Reading — Passage Level

Say: "Read this passage out loud. Start at The Ship. Move up or down based on comfort."

K — The Cat (CVC short vowels)	1st — The Ship (blends + digraphs)	2nd — A Day at the Lake (silent e + vowel teams)	3rd — The Picnic Plan (multisyllabic)
✓ X	✓ X	✓ X	✓ X

Highest passage reached: _____ Hesitated / struggled on: _____

Passage level where fluency breaks down = reading placement. Hesitations point to exact phonics pattern to target.

Where to Go Next

	Then focus on...
Can't rhyme	Phonological Awareness — start here before any phonics
Misses letter sounds	Alphabet Knowledge
Can't spell 'sat'	Phonics & Decoding — UFLI Units 1-4
Can't spell 'ship'	Phonics & Decoding — UFLI Units 5-7 (digraphs)
Can't spell 'cake'	Phonics & Decoding — UFLI Unit 14 (magic-e)
Real words OK, nonsense fails	Phonics Automaticity — memorization flag
Reads K passage only	Oral Reading Fluency — K level texts
Reads through 2nd grade	Vowel teams + r-controlled — UFLI Units 15-20

Notes